

Door 3 — music production and studio craft, every European option in one file

Making records: production, studio practice, mixing, mastering, Tonmeister, sound direction, popular-music production, beat-making, DJ and electronic production.

Not electroacoustic composition, sound art, installation or sonology — those are Door 1 and live in `ARTIST-ROUTE.xlsx`.

Everything this project collected across every earlier sweep, merged with the new Door-3 campaign. Nothing was searched twice.

Records	398
Real master's degrees	261
Sold as a master but not a degree	130
Award unclear — ask before applying	7
Reachable without a performance audition	247 of 261
Strong chance and cheap and no audition	29
Free or under €5,000/yr	90
Re-verified against official pages	127 — 8 worth it · 33 conditional · 86 avoid
Funding schemes found for this door	49

Spread across **37 countries**: United Kingdom 34 · France 28 · Italy 26 · Germany 24 · Belgium 17 · Netherlands 13 · Switzerland 11 · Bulgaria and Czech Republic 8 · Austria, Poland, Spain and Sweden 7 · and the rest across Denmark, Ireland, Romania, Finland, Norway, Portugal, Serbia, Slovakia, Estonia, Greece, Hungary, Turkey, Croatia, Latvia, Lithuania, Slovenia, Albania, Armenia, Cyprus, Georgia, Iceland, Malta, Montenegro and North Macedonia.

The thing to understand before reading the list

A practical production test is not an audition.

Door 3 programmes gate in three different ways, and they are not equally hard for you:

Gate	What it means	Can you pass it?
Portfolio	Submit 2–4 finished tracks	Yes — this is a twelve-month build
Production test	"Here is raw material, make a production"	Yes — this is the job, not a barrier
Ear-training / performance audition	Play an instrument, identify intervals, sight-read	No — this needs conservatoire training

Only **14 of 261** demand a performance audition outright. The rest are reachable.

The German Tonmeister degrees are closed — but not for the reason I first gave

Verification overturned this. **Detmold's** master aptitude test is *three of your own productions on CD/DVD plus a 30-minute colloquium* — **no ear test, no audition**. The **Royal Danish Academy** runs **no live entrance exam at all**: two productions of 7+ minutes and a 20-minute discussion. **CNSMD Paris** gates on the conservatoire *DEM*.

What closes them is a **prerequisite degree** — Detmold demands a "*Bachelor of Music Musikübertragung bzw. Diplom-Tonmeister*", Copenhagen a "*Bachelor of Music as tonemeister*" — plus, at Detmold, German C1. The ear tests live on the **bachelor** entrance, not the master's. Only **FAMU** and **Robert Schumann Düsseldorf** genuinely gate on musicianship.

That distinction matters: a closed prerequisite degree is sometimes negotiable by equivalence. A trained ear is not something you acquire in a year.

Two things that look like ear tests and are not: Novi Sad's *ayduozpam* and mdw Vienna's "*Nachweis der einwandfreien Gehörfähigkeit*" are **medical hearing certificates**.

The 29 that are a strong chance, cheap, and need no audition

The full list is on the workbook's **** BEST BETS**** tab. These are the ones worth acting on:

Programme	Where	Cost to you	Gate
FHNW Basel — MA Producing, Schwerpunkt Realisation	Basel	CHF 2,500/yr	One self-produced mix + a method PDF. No ear training, no compulsory audition, round two online on request . Language: " <i>gute Grundkenntnisse in Englisch</i> " — no German
HfMT Köln — Production (M.Mus.)	Cologne	€0	"You prepare a production from the (raw) material you receive from us." German A2 . Deadline 2 March
İTÜ MIAM — Sound Engineering & Design	Istanbul	~€1,000/yr	Portfolio + interview. English. Türkiye Bursları can make it free
FH Joanneum Graz — Sound Design	Graz	€1,454/yr	Entirely in English, IELTS 5.0 , video interview, five rounds a year
Masaryk Brno — Zvukový design	Brno	Free	"Určen absolventům bakalářského studia – bez omezení" — any bachelor's. Interview + a 2-page project. Czech-taught
Universidade de Coimbra — Computação Musical e Design de Som	Coimbra	Low	Entry list names Informática first . No audition, no portfolio published. Portuguese and English
UBO Brest — Master Image & Son	Brest	€3,941 + CVEC	No audition and no portfolio — dossier and interview. Entry via a science licence

Programme	Where	Cost to you	Gate
Saint Louis College of Music — Music Production	Rome	~€2,800/yr	Portfolio only
ESAV Toulouse — Cinéma et audiovisuel, parcours Son	Toulouse	€3,941	Entry list names <i>"de l'informatique"</i>
Conservatorio Vibo Valentia — Tecnico del Suono	Vibo Valentia	Low	A mixing test, prior works and an interview. No audition, no ear test
HSLU Lucerne — Music and Digital Creation	Lucerne	CHF 2,600/yr	"A bachelor's... is sufficient – regardless of the degree programme." Portfolio = one A4 page . German A2
HfM Karlsruhe — M.A. Musikinformatik	Karlsruhe	€3,000/yr	Portfolio may be "Software o.ä." — your code counts . Deadline 15 June
DkIT — MA Creative Practice	Dundalk	€12,000 total	Entry list names "technology" . No audition, no ear test. English
Conservatorium van Amsterdam	Amsterdam	—	The purest production test found: <i>"create in 10 minutes an on-the-spot stereo mix of a pre-recorded 24-track session in Pro Tools"</i>

Also on the tab: **Politecnico di Milano** (English), **TU Ilmenau** and **Sibelius Academy Music Technology** (both free — but Ilmenau's language rule is unpublished and Sibelius has **no 2027 intake**), **Le Fresnoy**, **ENS Louis-Lumière**, **ENSATT**, **Aix-Marseille**, **Lyon 2**, **Gustave Eiffel**, **UPHF Valenciennes**, **Le Mans**, **FH Salzburg**, **Filmakademie Baden-Württemberg**, **HKU Utrecht**, **Metropolitan Belgrade**, **RISEBA Riga**, **Athens**.

A fee correction the cost column has not caught up with. **IAD** and every Wallonian institution charge **€5,369/yr** (€1,194 + a €4,175 supplement) and **KASK Gent** **€8,800/yr**. Tunisia is **not** on the ARES exemption list. Both appear in the cheap band and are not cheap — unless you win a **WBI bursary**, which waives the supplement *and* funds you. **Tunisia is an explicit WBI priority country**, and that is the highest-value Belgian application available.

The free ones, and why most of them are still closed

Thirteen European Door-3 degrees cost you nothing. Only three are a realistic chance:

Possible for you - HfMT Köln — Production (M.Mus.) — €0, German **A2**, portfolio is **two audio files** from the last two years plus documentation of your working method. The entrance test is *"candidates receive raw material and must create a production."* The single best free option in this door. - **HAW Hamburg — Zeitabhängige Medien / Sound-Vision (M.A.)** — €0, German, project-centred study across sound and moving image. - **Filmuniversität Babelsberg — M.A. Tonmeister für audiovisuelle Medien** — €0, German.

Free but rated Weak — the Tonmeister wall Detmold (Erich-Thienhaus-Institut, four separate records), Robert Schumann Düsseldorf, Babelsberg's other sound tracks, and FAMU Prague. These are excellent, famous, free — and every one of them assumes instrumental ability and ear training. They are the reason "free" is not the same as "reachable."

What verification found

127 of 398 records have now been re-opened on the institutions' own pages: **8 worth it, 33 conditional, 86 avoid**. Every one of the 96 legacy European records is done.

The **86 avoids** are the point of the exercise — each is an application you now don't have to make.

Records still carrying a blank verdict have **not** been re-checked. Treat them as leads.

The 130 that are not degrees

A third of everything sold as a master's in this door is not one — the highest proportion of any field this project has searched. Door 3 is where the private audio-school market lives.

The pattern by country: **Netherlands** — Abbey Road Institute Amsterdam, SAE Amsterdam, DJ School Amsterdam, Dutch Dance Music Academy, Herman Brood Academie, Master The Mix, Music Production Academy, Pro Audio Education NL, Sound Education Nederland. **Spain** — Microfusa, CEV, CICE, Aula Creativa, Point Blank Ibiza, SAE Spain, and *título propio* programmes at TAI, UCAM and Francisco de Vitoria. **Italy** — Accademia del Suono, SAE Milano, Scuola Mohole, and IULM's *Master di I livello*. **Portugal** — ETIC, Restart, DJEM, EMMA. **France** — ESIS, EICAR, CinéCréatis, MJM and ATLA all sell a "*Mastère*" that is **RNCP level 5 or 6**, bachelor level or below; **3iS** likewise, at €15,000/yr for two years.

The UK validation chain, now traced: ICMP awards its own degrees — full degree-awarding powers since November 2021, so it is *not* a validated provider. But **SAE Glasgow's identically-named MA is awarded by the University of Hertfordshire**. The rest: **dBs Falmouth, Thinkspace AUB, Leeds Conservatoire Hull, ACM Middlesex. Point Blank has no postgraduate provision at all**. And **dBs accepts international students on its online programmes only** — which means **no student visa**.

They are all on the **NOT a degree — avoid** tab with the reason for each. Read it before you pay anyone.

Money, by country

Where	What you pay	Note
Germany	€0 in most states	The catch is a closed prerequisite degree and German, not the fee. Bavaria may now charge up to €6,000/semester
Turkey	~€1,000/yr	Plus Türkiye Bursları — fully funded, under-30, arts window 10 Jan – 20 Feb
Switzerland	CHF 2,100–2,600/yr	Far cheaper than assumed. Only FHNW applies a true third-country rate

Where	What you pay	Note
Italy	Low after <i>ISEE parificato</i> ; regional DSU worth €7,072–7,171/yr to a <i>fuori sede</i> student	An ISEE parificato needs home-country income documents translated and consular-legalised — start it months early or you sit in the top band in year one
France	€3,941/yr differentiated	Unless it is a Ministry of Culture school. Campus France Tunisie closes ~15 January 2027
Belgium — Wallonia	€5,369/yr	Decree-set, identical everywhere. Tunisia not exempt . WBI bursary waives it
Belgium — Flanders	KASK €8,800 · LUCA €9,824 · KC Brussel €17,501 · KC Antwerpen €25,000	Flanders removed non-EEA students from basic financing
Czechia	€0 if taught in Czech	Free to every nationality — this is how Masaryk Brno is free
Bulgaria	€5,522–€8,500/yr	The domestic rate does not apply to you
Norway / Finland	NOK 135,000–401,704 · Uniarts €28,000	Norway now charges everywhere; no covering scholarship
UK	£15,000–£30,000	Chevening is closed to you — it needs two years' post-degree work experience, and GREAT and Commonwealth both exclude Tunisia

Money — 49 schemes, and the pattern behind them

Nationality was rarely the bar. Subject was. Eiffel excludes the arts, NAWA Banach is STEM-only (Tunisia is listed), the Islamic Development Bank funds science and engineering, the OPEC Fund funds development. **Your software-engineering BSc fits all four — the master's subject is what fails them.**

The eight worth pursuing

Scheme	What it pays	Why it fits
Tunisian bourse d'études à l'étranger (best.rnu.tn)	Tuition + €800/month + social security + health insurance + travel	Your own government — no nationality bar at all . Two unknowns decide it: whether arts and music are eligible fields, and whether an admission letter is needed at application. Circulaire publishes ~October 2026
Italian MAECI AFAM scholarship	€10,800 + medical insurance	Article 1.2 explicitly names AFAM music courses , and it stacks with the regional DSU grant . Age cap 28. Deadline ~26 March
AESEF (Audio Engineering Society Educational Foundation)	~USD 2–5k, plus the Dolby Institute and L-Acoustics awards on the same form	The L-Acoustics award invites applicants whose undergraduate degree was "in an area other than audio." No admission required, no work experience, no IELTS, worldwide. Deadline 15 May

Scheme	What it pays	Why it fits
ICMP Andrew Scheps Scholarship	Full tuition , MSc Audio Engineering and Music Technology	No nationality clause. Judged on portfolio and video, not transcript
Romanian MFA scholarships	Tuition + stipend	No nationality list, all fields, no admission-first requirement , application platform in French. Deadline 31 March
UAL International Postgraduate Scholarship	£10,000 (a £50,000 tier exists)	Tunisia's presence on the eligible list is unconfirmed
Huddersfield PG Merit + General Entry	£4,000–5,000	Automatic and non-competitive , on an on-subject MSc
Estonian bilateral (€350/mo) + EAMT's 25–50% waiver	Together, workable	Tunisia is named on Harno's list . Only viable as the pair

Hidden work-experience bars that would disqualify you: **Popakademie** needs six months' industry experience plus C1 German · **CNM** needs French tax residence and regular professional activity in France · **PRS Foundation** needs a UK base and an 18-month track record · **Help Musicians** needs three years living and studying in the UK, and excludes music technology outright · **ICMP's own** PG scholarship needs three years' UK/EEA residency · **Fundación SGAE** requires existing membership.

Erasmus+ International Credit Mobility cannot fund a full master's. It caps physical mobility at 12 months, is defined as credit mobility inside ongoing studies, and requires you to remain enrolled at a Tunisian institution. It does not belong in your plan.

Country schemes checked and closed: Latvia and Czechia exclude Tunisia. Greece's postgraduate stream is not open. Iceland funds Icelandic studies only. Portugal (Camões) and Spain (MAEC-AECID) have no live foreign master's line. Lithuania, Croatia, Serbia and Bulgaria **publish no retrievable country list at all** — genuinely unknown rather than negative. Abbey Road requires a UK passport; SSL is UK-based and undergraduate.

Earliest 2027 deadlines: Eiffel and Prince Claus **8 January** · IsDB **31 January** · RMC Copenhagen **3 February** · MAECI **26 March** · Romania **31 March** · NAWA **early May** (country quotas can close it weeks early) · AESEF **15 May**. Watch from **autumn 2026**: the Tunisian circulaire, and UAL's 2027/28 international applications opening.

One deadline is nearly here: the Royal Danish Academy closes 1 December 2026 for autumn 2027.

What is still unfinished — stated plainly

- **~40 Italian conservatoires** could not be read — Milano, Torino, Venezia, Parma, Palermo, Trieste, Udine, Perugia among them. They block automated fetching or render course pages in JavaScript. Listed by name in the workbook rather than treated as absences.
- **271 of 398 records** still carry no verdict.

- **Portfolio specs are thin in Italy** — exactly one exact specification was found in the whole country (Firenze: three works, 60 s to 3 min, emailed ten days ahead — and that one carries a disqualifying piano performance test).
- **Łódź does not publish a non-EU fee for Polish-taught study.** It could be near-free. One email.
- **TU Ilmenau's language requirement is unpublished** — the English route is stated, but no CEFR level or certificate list. The whole value of that free entry rests on it.
- **ABPU Linz** would not render its master list; it has a professor of jazz saxophone *and music production*, which usually means production teaching sits inside an existing master.
- Unconfirmed: Tunisia on the MAECI and UAL country lists; the Tunisian *bourse's* field eligibility; AESEF's exact amounts.

No figure in this file was invented to fill a gap. Anything unconfirmed reads **UNVERIFIED**.

What to do with this now

1. **Build the portfolio — two to four finished tracks, and record at least one real source.** HfMT Köln asks for exactly two. FHNW Basel asks for **one** mix plus a method note. Saint Louis asks for a portfolio and nothing else. ITÜ wants **three mixes each containing an acoustically miked source** — so you need to record something real, not only produce in the box. That single constraint should shape what you build over the next year.
2. **FHNW Basel is the strongest single target.** Its start date is already published — **13 September 2027** — the window is **15 December 2026 – 15 February 2027**, round two can be done online, and it asks for **no German at all**.
3. **Send three emails this month.** HfMT Köln (jonathan.podmore@hfmt-koeln.de) — does a BSc Software Engineering count as an "*affine subject*"? That decides your best free option. TU Ilmenau — what English certificate does the English route actually require? Łódź — what does a non-EU student pay for Polish-taught study?
4. **Apply for the WBI bursary before choosing a Belgian programme.** Tunisia is an explicit priority country, and the bursary waives the €4,175 supplement as well as funding you.
5. **Diarise: Royal Danish Academy 1 December 2026 · Eiffel and Prince Claus 8 January · Türkiye Bursları arts 10 January – 20 February · FHNW Basel 15 December – 15 February · Campus France Tunisie closes ~15 January 2027 · AESEF 15 May.**